

1000+ Cybersecurity Words

Every term with a plain-word twin and a one-line meaning

Grouped by topic • Easy English • Made for learners and creators

How to read each row

TERM the real word	ALSO CALLED an easy twin word	SIMPLE MEANING one plain line
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Note: most security words have no true synonym. So the middle column is not a fake synonym — it is the everyday phrase people actually use, or the full form of the short name. That teaches the right idea, not a wrong one.

CORE CONCEPTS

#	TERM	ALSO CALLED	SIMPLE MEANING
1	Cybersecurity	<i>Information security, InfoSec</i>	Protecting computers, networks and data from theft or damage.
2	CIA Triad	<i>Security triangle</i>	The 3 core goals: keep data secret, correct, and available.
3	Confidentiality	<i>Secrecy</i>	Only allowed people can see the data.
4	Integrity	<i>Trustworthiness</i>	Data is correct and not secretly changed.
5	Availability	<i>Uptime</i>	Systems and data work when needed.
6	Authentication	<i>Identity check</i>	Proving you are who you claim to be.
7	Authorization	<i>Permission check</i>	Deciding what an identified user is allowed to do.
8	Accounting	<i>Auditing</i>	Recording what each user did.
9	Non-repudiation	<i>Undeniable proof</i>	You can't deny you did an action.
10	Vulnerability	<i>Weakness, hole</i>	A flaw an attacker can misuse.
11	Threat	<i>Danger</i>	Anything that could cause harm.
12	Risk	<i>Exposure</i>	Chance of harm = threat meeting a weakness.
13	Exploit	<i>Attack code</i>	A trick or code that uses a weakness.
14	Attack	<i>Intrusion attempt</i>	An action meant to break security.
15	Attack surface	<i>Exposed area</i>	All the ways an attacker could get in.
16	Attack vector	<i>Entry path</i>	The specific route an attacker uses.
17	Payload	<i>Harmful part</i>	The part of an attack that does the damage.
18	Threat actor	<i>Attacker, adversary</i>	The person or group behind an attack.
19	Asset	<i>Valuable item</i>	Anything worth protecting (data, servers, people).
20	Countermeasure	<i>Control, safeguard</i>	Something that reduces risk.
21	Security control	<i>Protection measure</i>	A rule or tool that lowers risk.
22	Mitigation	<i>Reduction</i>	Steps that lessen the impact of a threat.
23	Remediation	<i>Fix</i>	Fully removing or repairing a weakness.
24	Hardening	<i>Locking down</i>	Removing weak settings to make a system tougher.
25	Baseline	<i>Standard config</i>	The known-good settings to compare against.
26	Defense in depth	<i>Layered security</i>	Many layers of protection, not just one.
27	Least privilege	<i>Minimum access</i>	Give only the access truly needed.
28	Zero trust	<i>Never trust, always verify</i>	Trust nothing by default; check every request.
29	Separation of duties	<i>Split control</i>	No single person controls a whole risky task.
30	Fail-safe	<i>Safe default</i>	On failure, the system locks instead of opening.
31	Air gap	<i>Physical isolation</i>	A machine with no network connection at all.
32	Blast radius	<i>Damage spread</i>	How far harm reaches if one part is breached.
33	Security posture	<i>Overall strength</i>	How well protected an organization is right now.
34	Threat landscape	<i>Danger map</i>	The full picture of current threats.
35	Exposure	<i>Openness</i>	A weakness that is reachable by attackers.
36	Compromise	<i>Breach</i>	When a system falls under attacker control.
37	Breach	<i>Data leak</i>	Unauthorized access to protected data.
38	Incident	<i>Security event</i>	Any event that harms or threatens security.
39	Event	<i>Log entry</i>	Any recorded system activity.
40	Indicator of Compromise	<i>IOC, clue</i>	Evidence that a breach happened (e.g. bad IP).
41	Indicator of Attack	<i>IOA</i>	Signs an attack is in progress.
42	Kill chain	<i>Attack stages</i>	The step-by-step path of a full attack.
43	MITRE ATT&CK;	<i>Attack playbook</i>	A public library of attacker techniques.
44	TTP	<i>Attacker behavior</i>	Tactics, Techniques and Procedures of attackers.
45	Root cause	<i>Origin</i>	The true underlying reason a problem happened.

#	TERM	ALSO CALLED	SIMPLE MEANING
46	Residual risk	<i>Leftover risk</i>	Risk that remains after controls are applied.
47	Acceptable risk	<i>Tolerated risk</i>	Risk small enough to live with.
48	Security by design	<i>Built-in security</i>	Adding security from the start, not later.
49	Security by obscurity	<i>Hiding as defense</i>	Relying on secrecy alone (weak, discouraged).
50	Threat model	<i>Risk map</i>	A plan of what could go wrong and how.

ATTACKS & THREATS

#	TERM	ALSO CALLED	SIMPLE MEANING
51	Phishing	<i>Bait email</i>	Fake messages that trick you into giving secrets.
52	Spear phishing	<i>Targeted phishing</i>	Phishing aimed at one specific person.
53	Whaling	<i>Executive phishing</i>	Phishing aimed at bosses or VIPs.
54	Vishing	<i>Voice phishing</i>	Phishing done over phone calls.
55	Smishing	<i>SMS phishing</i>	Phishing done through text messages.
56	Pharming	<i>Redirect attack</i>	Sending users to fake sites secretly.
57	Social engineering	<i>Human hacking</i>	Fooling people instead of machines.
58	Pretexting	<i>Fake story</i>	Inventing a lie to gain trust and info.
59	Baiting	<i>Lure trap</i>	Leaving tempting bait like a USB stick.
60	Quid pro quo	<i>Fake help</i>	Offering a favor to steal access.
61	Tailgating	<i>Piggybacking</i>	Sneaking through a door behind someone.
62	Impersonation	<i>Pretending</i>	Acting as someone you are not.
63	Business Email Compromise	<i>BEC, CEO fraud</i>	Faking a boss's email to steal money.
64	Brute force	<i>Guess-all</i>	Trying every password until one works.
65	Dictionary attack	<i>Wordlist attack</i>	Trying common words as passwords.
66	Credential stuffing	<i>Reused-password attack</i>	Using leaked passwords on other sites.
67	Password spraying	<i>Slow guessing</i>	Trying one common password on many accounts.
68	Rainbow table	<i>Precomputed hashes</i>	A lookup table to crack hashed passwords fast.
69	Man-in-the-Middle	<i>MITM, eavesdropper</i>	Secretly sitting between two parties.
70	On-path attack	<i>MITM</i>	Newer name for man-in-the-middle.
71	Replay attack	<i>Repeat trick</i>	Reusing captured data to fool a system.
72	Session hijacking	<i>Session theft</i>	Stealing a logged-in session token.
73	Session fixation	<i>Forced session</i>	Tricking a user into a known session ID.
74	Denial of Service	<i>DoS</i>	Flooding a system so it stops working.
75	DDoS	<i>Distributed flood</i>	A DoS from many machines at once.
76	Amplification attack	<i>Reflection flood</i>	Small requests that trigger huge replies.
77	Botnet	<i>Zombie army</i>	A network of hijacked machines.
78	Zero-day	<i>Unknown flaw</i>	A weakness no fix exists for yet.
79	Supply chain attack	<i>Vendor attack</i>	Hacking a trusted supplier to reach victims.
80	Watering hole	<i>Trap site</i>	Infecting a site the target often visits.
81	Drive-by download	<i>Silent infection</i>	Getting malware just by visiting a page.
82	Clickjacking	<i>UI trick</i>	Hiding buttons so clicks do hidden actions.
83	Typosquatting	<i>Fake-domain trap</i>	Registering misspelled domains to catch typos.
84	Domain hijacking	<i>Domain theft</i>	Stealing control of a domain name.
85	DNS spoofing	<i>DNS poisoning</i>	Feeding fake DNS answers to redirect users.
86	ARP spoofing	<i>ARP poisoning</i>	Faking network addresses to intercept traffic.
87	IP spoofing	<i>Fake source IP</i>	Forging the sender address of packets.
88	MAC spoofing	<i>Fake hardware ID</i>	Faking a device's hardware address.
89	Eavesdropping	<i>Sniffing, snooping</i>	Secretly listening to network traffic.
90	Packet sniffing	<i>Traffic capture</i>	Reading data packets on a network.

#	TERM	ALSO CALLED	SIMPLE MEANING
91	Keylogging	<i>Keystroke capture</i>	Recording everything typed on a keyboard.
92	Privilege escalation	<i>Level-up attack</i>	Gaining higher access than allowed.
93	Lateral movement	<i>Sideways spread</i>	Hopping from one machine to another inside.
94	Pivoting	<i>Jump point</i>	Using one hacked host to reach others.
95	Data exfiltration	<i>Data theft</i>	Sneaking stolen data out of a network.
96	Living off the land	<i>LOLBins</i>	Abusing built-in tools to avoid detection.
97	Fileless attack	<i>Memory attack</i>	Malware that runs in RAM, not on disk.
98	Injection	<i>Code insertion</i>	Slipping malicious commands into input.
99	SQL injection	<i>SQLi</i>	Injecting database commands via input fields.
100	Command injection	<i>OS injection</i>	Running system commands through an app.
101	Cross-Site Scripting	<i>XSS</i>	Injecting scripts that run in others' browsers.
102	Cross-Site Request Forgery	<i>CSRF</i>	Tricking a browser into unwanted actions.
103	Server-Side Request Forgery	<i>SSRF</i>	Making a server fetch attacker-chosen URLs.
104	Directory traversal	<i>Path attack</i>	Escaping a folder to read other files.
105	Buffer overflow	<i>Memory overflow</i>	Writing past memory limits to run code.
106	Race condition	<i>Timing bug</i>	Exploiting the gap between check and use.
107	Insider threat	<i>Rogue employee</i>	A trusted person who causes harm.
108	Shoulder surfing	<i>Peeking</i>	Watching a screen or keypad over a shoulder.
109	Dumpster diving	<i>Trash search</i>	Finding secrets in discarded papers or drives.
110	Evil twin	<i>Fake Wi-Fi</i>	A rogue Wi-Fi that mimics a real one.
111	Rogue access point	<i>Unauthorized AP</i>	A hidden Wi-Fi added without permission.
112	Deauth attack	<i>Kick-off attack</i>	Forcing devices off a Wi-Fi network.
113	Bluejacking	<i>BT spam</i>	Sending unwanted messages over Bluetooth.
114	Bluesnarfing	<i>BT theft</i>	Stealing data over a Bluetooth link.
115	Wardriving	<i>Wi-Fi hunting</i>	Driving around to find open networks.
116	Deepfake	<i>AI fake</i>	AI-made fake video, image or voice.
117	Prompt injection	<i>AI manipulation</i>	Tricking an AI with hidden instructions.
118	Cryptojacking	<i>Coin mining hijack</i>	Secretly using your device to mine crypto.
119	Ransomware attack	<i>Extortion attack</i>	Locking data and demanding payment.
120	Double extortion	<i>Leak + lock</i>	Steal data, then also encrypt and threaten to leak.
121	Wiper attack	<i>Data destroyer</i>	Malware built only to delete data.
122	Logic bomb trigger	<i>Time bomb</i>	Hidden code that fires on a condition.
123	Watering the target	<i>Recon</i>	Studying a victim before attacking.
124	Enumeration	<i>Info gathering</i>	Listing users, shares or services of a target.
125	Fingerprinting	<i>ID scanning</i>	Identifying software and versions in use.
126	Spoofing	<i>Faking identity</i>	Pretending to be a trusted source.
127	Poisoning	<i>Data corruption</i>	Feeding bad data to mislead a system.

MALWARE TYPES

#	TERM	ALSO CALLED	SIMPLE MEANING
128	Malware	<i>Malicious software</i>	Any software built to harm or steal.
129	Virus	<i>Infector</i>	Malware that attaches to files and spreads.
130	Worm	<i>Self-spreader</i>	Malware that copies itself across networks.
131	Trojan	<i>Trojan horse</i>	Malware hidden inside a useful-looking app.
132	Ransomware	<i>Lockware</i>	Malware that encrypts data for ransom.
133	Spyware	<i>Snoopware</i>	Software that secretly watches you.
134	Adware	<i>Ad malware</i>	Software that forces unwanted ads.

#	TERM	ALSO CALLED	SIMPLE MEANING
135	Rootkit	<i>Deep hider</i>	Malware that hides itself deep in the system.
136	Bootkit	<i>Boot malware</i>	A rootkit that infects the startup process.
137	Keylogger	<i>Key recorder</i>	Tool that records keystrokes.
138	Backdoor	<i>Secret entrance</i>	A hidden way back into a system.
139	Bot	<i>Zombie</i>	An infected machine an attacker controls.
140	Rat	<i>Remote Access Trojan</i>	Malware giving full remote control.
141	Logic bomb	<i>Time bomb</i>	Code that harms when a condition is met.
142	Dropper	<i>Loader</i>	Small malware that installs bigger malware.
143	Downloader	<i>Fetcher</i>	Malware that pulls in more malware.
144	Loader	<i>Stager</i>	First-stage code that loads the real payload.
145	Stealer	<i>Info-stealer</i>	Malware that grabs passwords and data.
146	Wiper	<i>Destroyer</i>	Malware that erases data permanently.
147	Cryptominer	<i>Coinminer</i>	Malware that mines crypto on your device.
148	Fileless malware	<i>Memory malware</i>	Malware living only in memory.
149	Polymorphic malware	<i>Shape-shifter</i>	Malware that changes its code to hide.
150	Metamorphic malware	<i>Rewriter</i>	Malware that fully rewrites itself each time.
151	Scareware	<i>Fear malware</i>	Fake alerts that scare you into paying.
152	Grayware	<i>Nuisance software</i>	Annoying but not clearly malicious apps.
153	PUP	<i>Unwanted program</i>	Potentially Unwanted Program bundled in installs.
154	Macro virus	<i>Document malware</i>	Malware inside document macros.
155	Ransomware-as-a-Service	<i>RaaS</i>	Rented ransomware kits for criminals.
156	Malware-as-a-Service	<i>MaaS</i>	Malware sold as a paid service.
157	Command and Control	<i>C2, C&C;</i>	The server that controls infected machines.
158	Beacon	<i>Check-in signal</i>	Regular calls from malware to its C2.
159	Payload dropper	<i>Installer</i>	Component that plants the harmful payload.
160	Exploit kit	<i>Attack toolkit</i>	A packaged set of ready-made exploits.
161	Malvertising	<i>Bad ads</i>	Ads that deliver malware.
162	Spyware toolkit	<i>Surveillance kit</i>	A bundle of spying tools.
163	Trojan downloader	<i>Hidden fetcher</i>	A trojan whose job is fetching malware.
164	Banking trojan	<i>Bank stealer</i>	Malware that steals banking logins.
165	Mobile malware	<i>Phone malware</i>	Malware targeting phones and tablets.
166	Firmware malware	<i>Chip malware</i>	Malware living in device firmware.

NETWORK SECURITY

#	TERM	ALSO CALLED	SIMPLE MEANING
167	Network	<i>Connected systems</i>	Devices linked to share data.
168	Firewall	<i>Traffic gate</i>	Filters network traffic by rules.
169	Next-gen firewall	<i>NGFW</i>	A firewall that also inspects apps and threats.
170	Packet filter	<i>Basic firewall</i>	Allows or blocks packets by simple rules.
171	Stateful firewall	<i>Connection-aware filter</i>	Tracks whole connections, not single packets.
172	Proxy	<i>Middleman server</i>	A server that forwards requests for you.
173	Reverse proxy	<i>Front server</i>	A proxy that sits in front of servers.
174	Web proxy	<i>Web gateway</i>	A proxy that filters web browsing.
175	NAT	<i>Address translation</i>	Shares one public IP among many devices.
176	VPN	<i>Secure tunnel</i>	An encrypted link over the internet.
177	Tunnel	<i>Wrapped path</i>	A protected channel inside another network.
178	VLAN	<i>Virtual LAN</i>	A logical split of one physical network.

#	TERM	ALSO CALLED	SIMPLE MEANING
179	Segmentation	<i>Network splitting</i>	Dividing a network to limit spread.
180	Microsegmentation	<i>Fine splitting</i>	Very small, tight network zones.
181	DMZ	<i>Buffer zone</i>	A semi-open zone between inside and outside.
182	IDS	<i>Intrusion Detection System</i>	Watches traffic and alerts on attacks.
183	IPS	<i>Intrusion Prevention System</i>	Detects and blocks attacks live.
184	NIDS	<i>Network IDS</i>	An IDS watching network traffic.
185	HIDS	<i>Host IDS</i>	An IDS watching a single machine.
186	Honeypot	<i>Decoy trap</i>	A fake target set to catch attackers.
187	Honeynet	<i>Decoy network</i>	A whole fake network to trap attackers.
188	Sinkhole	<i>Traffic trap</i>	Redirecting bad traffic to a dead end.
189	Port	<i>Connection door</i>	A numbered channel for a network service.
190	Port scanning	<i>Door knocking</i>	Checking which ports are open.
191	Packet	<i>Data chunk</i>	A small unit of network data.
192	Protocol	<i>Rules of talk</i>	Agreed rules for devices to communicate.
193	TCP	<i>Reliable transport</i>	A protocol that guarantees delivery order.
194	UDP	<i>Fast transport</i>	A quick protocol with no delivery promise.
195	IP address	<i>Network address</i>	A number identifying a device on a network.
196	MAC address	<i>Hardware address</i>	A device's built-in network ID.
197	DNS	<i>Name lookup</i>	Turns names like site.com into IP addresses.
198	DHCP	<i>Auto-address</i>	Hands out IP addresses automatically.
199	Gateway	<i>Exit door</i>	The device that leads to other networks.
200	Router	<i>Traffic director</i>	Sends data between networks.
201	Switch	<i>Traffic connector</i>	Links devices inside one network.
202	Access point	<i>Wi-Fi hub</i>	A device giving wireless access.
203	Load balancer	<i>Traffic spreader</i>	Splits work across many servers.
204	Bandwidth	<i>Data capacity</i>	How much data a link can carry.
205	Latency	<i>Delay</i>	Time for data to travel across a network.
206	Packet loss	<i>Dropped data</i>	Packets that never reach their target.
207	Traffic analysis	<i>Flow study</i>	Studying traffic patterns for clues.
208	Deep packet inspection	<i>DPI</i>	Looking inside packets, not just headers.
209	Network tap	<i>Traffic mirror</i>	A device that copies traffic for monitoring.
210	SPAN port	<i>Mirror port</i>	A switch port that copies traffic.
211	Egress filtering	<i>Outbound control</i>	Controlling what leaves the network.
212	Ingress filtering	<i>Inbound control</i>	Controlling what enters the network.
213	Allowlist	<i>Whitelist</i>	A list of only what is permitted.
214	Blocklist	<i>Blacklist</i>	A list of what is forbidden.
215	Geofencing	<i>Location blocking</i>	Blocking access by geographic area.
216	Rate limiting	<i>Speed cap</i>	Limiting how many requests are allowed.
217	Network access control	<i>NAC</i>	Checks devices before letting them on.
218	802.1X	<i>Port auth</i>	A standard to authenticate devices at ports.
219	SSID	<i>Wi-Fi name</i>	The public name of a wireless network.
220	WPA2	<i>Wi-Fi security</i>	A common Wi-Fi encryption standard.
221	WPA3	<i>Newer Wi-Fi security</i>	The latest Wi-Fi encryption standard.
222	WEP	<i>Old Wi-Fi security</i>	An outdated, broken Wi-Fi encryption.
223	SSL stripping	<i>Downgrade attack</i>	Forcing a secure link back to insecure.
224	Split tunneling	<i>Partial VPN</i>	Sending some traffic outside the VPN.

#	TERM	ALSO CALLED	SIMPLE MEANING
225	Jump box	<i>Bastion host</i>	A hardened gateway to access sensitive systems.
226	Bastion host	<i>Guarded gateway</i>	A locked-down entry server.

CRYPTOGRAPHY

#	TERM	ALSO CALLED	SIMPLE MEANING
227	Cryptography	<i>Secret writing</i>	The science of protecting data with math.
228	Encryption	<i>Scrambling</i>	Turning readable data into secret code.
229	Decryption	<i>Unscrambling</i>	Turning secret code back to readable data.
230	Plaintext	<i>Clear data</i>	Readable, unencrypted data.
231	Ciphertext	<i>Scrambled data</i>	Encrypted, unreadable data.
232	Cipher	<i>Code method</i>	The rule used to scramble data.
233	Key	<i>Secret code</i>	The value that locks or unlocks data.
234	Symmetric encryption	<i>Shared-key</i>	Same key locks and unlocks.
235	Asymmetric encryption	<i>Public-key</i>	One key locks, a different key unlocks.
236	Public key	<i>Shareable key</i>	A key you can give to anyone.
237	Private key	<i>Secret key</i>	A key you must keep hidden.
238	Key pair	<i>Matched keys</i>	A linked public and private key set.
239	AES	<i>Strong cipher</i>	A widely used symmetric encryption standard.
240	RSA	<i>Public-key cipher</i>	A common asymmetric encryption method.
241	ECC	<i>Elliptic curve</i>	Strong encryption using smaller keys.
242	DES	<i>Old cipher</i>	An outdated, weak symmetric cipher.
243	3DES	<i>Triple DES</i>	DES run three times; now retired.
244	Hashing	<i>Fingerprinting</i>	Turning data into a fixed unique code.
245	Hash	<i>Digest</i>	The fixed output of a hash function.
246	MD5	<i>Weak hash</i>	An old, broken hashing method.
247	SHA-256	<i>Strong hash</i>	A common secure hashing method.
248	Salt	<i>Random extra</i>	Random data added before hashing passwords.
249	Pepper	<i>Secret extra</i>	A hidden site-wide value added to hashes.
250	Collision	<i>Hash clash</i>	Two inputs giving the same hash.
251	Digital signature	<i>E-signature</i>	Proof that data came from a signer unaltered.
252	Certificate	<i>Digital ID</i>	A file proving a site or user's identity.
253	Certificate Authority	<i>CA</i>	A trusted body that issues certificates.
254	PKI	<i>Trust system</i>	The system managing keys and certificates.
255	Root certificate	<i>Trust anchor</i>	The top certificate everything trusts.
256	Chain of trust	<i>Trust path</i>	The linked certificates back to a root.
257	Self-signed cert	<i>Own certificate</i>	A certificate you signed yourself.
258	TLS	<i>Transport security</i>	Encrypts data moving over networks.
259	SSL	<i>Old TLS</i>	The older, retired version of TLS.
260	HTTPS	<i>Secure web</i>	HTTP protected with TLS encryption.
261	Handshake	<i>Setup chat</i>	The opening exchange to agree on encryption.
262	Session key	<i>Temporary key</i>	A short-lived key for one session.
263	Key exchange	<i>Key sharing</i>	Safely agreeing on a shared secret.
264	Diffie-Hellman	<i>DH key swap</i>	A method to share a key over open lines.
265	Perfect forward secrecy	<i>PFS</i>	Old sessions stay safe if a key leaks later.
266	Nonce	<i>One-time number</i>	A random value used only once.
267	Initialization vector	<i>IV</i>	Random start value for encryption.
268	Block cipher	<i>Chunk encryptor</i>	Encrypts data in fixed-size blocks.

#	TERM	ALSO CALLED	SIMPLE MEANING
269	Stream cipher	<i>Flow encryptor</i>	Encrypts data one bit at a time.
270	Key rotation	<i>Key refresh</i>	Regularly replacing keys.
271	Key escrow	<i>Key backup</i>	Storing a key copy with a trusted party.
272	HSM	<i>Hardware Security Module</i>	A hardware device that guards keys.
273	Entropy	<i>Randomness</i>	The amount of true unpredictability.
274	End-to-end encryption	<i>E2EE</i>	Only sender and receiver can read it.
275	At-rest encryption	<i>Stored encryption</i>	Encrypting saved data.
276	In-transit encryption	<i>Moving encryption</i>	Encrypting data while it travels.
277	Steganography	<i>Hidden data</i>	Hiding a message inside another file.
278	Obfuscation	<i>Confusion</i>	Making code or data hard to read.
279	Quantum cryptography	<i>Post-quantum</i>	Encryption meant to resist quantum computers.
280	Cryptanalysis	<i>Code-breaking</i>	The study of breaking encryption.
281	Message Authentication Code	<i>MAC</i>	A tag proving a message wasn't changed.
282	HMAC	<i>Keyed MAC</i>	A MAC built using a hash and a key.

IDENTITY & ACCESS MANAGEMENT

#	TERM	ALSO CALLED	SIMPLE MEANING
283	Identity	<i>Digital self</i>	Who a user or system is online.
284	IAM	<i>Identity management</i>	Managing who can access what.
285	Credential	<i>Login proof</i>	Something used to log in (password, key).
286	Password	<i>Secret phrase</i>	A private string used to log in.
287	Passphrase	<i>Long password</i>	A longer, sentence-like password.
288	Passwordless	<i>No-password login</i>	Logging in without a typed password.
289	Multi-Factor Authentication	<i>MFA</i>	Needing two or more proofs to log in.
290	Two-Factor Authentication	<i>2FA</i>	Needing exactly two proofs to log in.
291	One-Time Password	<i>OTP</i>	A code that works only once.
292	TOTP	<i>Time-based OTP</i>	A code that changes every 30 seconds.
293	Token	<i>Access pass</i>	A small item proving identity or access.
294	Hardware token	<i>Security key</i>	A physical device for login.
295	Soft token	<i>App token</i>	A login code from an app.
296	Biometrics	<i>Body login</i>	Using fingerprints or faces to log in.
297	Single Sign-On	<i>SSO</i>	One login for many apps.
298	Federation	<i>Trust sharing</i>	Letting one system trust another's logins.
299	OAuth	<i>Access delegation</i>	Letting apps access data without your password.
300	OpenID Connect	<i>OIDC</i>	An identity layer built on OAuth.
301	SAML	<i>Login exchange</i>	A standard for sharing login info between sites.
302	Kerberos	<i>Ticket auth</i>	A ticket-based network login system.
303	LDAP	<i>Directory protocol</i>	A way to look up users and groups.
304	Active Directory	<i>AD</i>	Microsoft's user and computer directory.
305	Directory service	<i>User database</i>	A central store of identities.
306	Role-Based Access Control	<i>RBAC</i>	Access based on your job role.
307	Attribute-Based Access Control	<i>ABAC</i>	Access based on many attributes.
308	Access Control List	<i>ACL</i>	A list of who can do what.

#	TERM	ALSO CALLED	SIMPLE MEANING
309	Privileged access	<i>Admin access</i>	High-power accounts and rights.
310	PAM	<i>Privileged Access Management</i>	Controlling powerful admin accounts.
311	Just-in-time access	<i>JIT</i>	Granting access only when needed, briefly.
312	Provisioning	<i>Account setup</i>	Creating and setting up user access.
313	Deprovisioning	<i>Account removal</i>	Removing access when no longer needed.
314	Identity provider	<i>IdP</i>	The system that verifies who you are.
315	Service provider	<i>SP</i>	The app that trusts the IdP's login.
316	Claim	<i>Identity fact</i>	A stated fact about a user (e.g. email).
317	Assertion	<i>Signed statement</i>	A trusted statement about a login.
318	Session	<i>Login period</i>	The time you stay logged in.
319	Cookie	<i>Session token</i>	Small data a site stores in your browser.
320	Token expiry	<i>Timeout</i>	When a login token stops working.
321	Refresh token	<i>Renewal token</i>	A token used to get new access tokens.
322	Access token	<i>Entry token</i>	A token proving current access rights.
323	Credential theft	<i>Login theft</i>	Stealing usernames and passwords.
324	Account takeover	<i>ATO</i>	An attacker seizing someone's account.
325	Password manager	<i>Vault app</i>	An app that stores your passwords safely.
326	Password vault	<i>Secret store</i>	A protected store for credentials.
327	Identity governance	<i>IGA</i>	Overseeing who has access and why.
328	Step-up authentication	<i>Extra check</i>	Asking for more proof for risky actions.
329	Adaptive authentication	<i>Smart login</i>	Login checks that adjust to risk.
330	Continuous authentication	<i>Ongoing check</i>	Constantly re-verifying the user.

WEB & APPLICATION SECURITY

#	TERM	ALSO CALLED	SIMPLE MEANING
331	Application security	<i>AppSec</i>	Protecting software from attacks.
332	Web application firewall	<i>WAF</i>	A firewall that filters web app traffic.
333	Input validation	<i>Input checking</i>	Making sure user input is safe.
334	Output encoding	<i>Safe output</i>	Escaping data so it can't run as code.
335	Sanitization	<i>Input cleaning</i>	Removing dangerous parts from input.
336	Parameterized query	<i>Prepared statement</i>	Safe database calls that block injection.
337	Same-origin policy	<i>SOP</i>	Rule keeping sites from reading each other.
338	CORS	<i>Cross-origin sharing</i>	Rules allowing safe cross-site requests.
339	Content Security Policy	<i>CSP</i>	Rules limiting what a page can load.
340	Secure cookie	<i>Protected cookie</i>	A cookie sent only over HTTPS.
341	HttpOnly cookie	<i>Script-blocked cookie</i>	A cookie JavaScript can't read.
342	SameSite cookie	<i>Cross-site guard</i>	A cookie rule that blocks CSRF.
343	CSRF token	<i>Anti-forgery token</i>	A secret proving a request is genuine.
344	Session management	<i>Login control</i>	Handling user sessions safely.
345	Broken authentication	<i>Weak login</i>	Flaws letting attackers bypass login.
346	Broken access control	<i>Weak permissions</i>	Users reaching things they shouldn't.
347	IDOR	<i>Object reference flaw</i>	Changing an ID to see others' data.
348	Security misconfiguration	<i>Bad setup</i>	Weak or default settings left in place.

#	TERM	ALSO CALLED	SIMPLE MEANING
349	Sensitive data exposure	<i>Data leak</i>	Secrets shown due to weak protection.
350	Insecure deserialization	<i>Object attack</i>	Abusing how apps rebuild saved objects.
351	XML External Entity	<i>XXE</i>	Abusing XML parsers to read files.
352	Server-side template injection	<i>SSTI</i>	Injecting code into page templates.
353	API security	<i>Interface security</i>	Protecting app-to-app connections.
354	API key	<i>Access key</i>	A secret string identifying an app caller.
355	Rate limit bypass	<i>Throttle evasion</i>	Getting around request limits.
356	Web shell	<i>Backdoor page</i>	A malicious script giving server control.
357	Cookie theft	<i>Session steal</i>	Stealing cookies to hijack a session.
358	Session token	<i>Login ID</i>	A secret that keeps you logged in.
359	OWASP Top 10	<i>Risk list</i>	The top 10 common web app risks.
360	Secure coding	<i>Safe coding</i>	Writing code that resists attacks.
361	Code review	<i>Peer check</i>	Reading code to find flaws.
362	SAST	<i>Static analysis</i>	Scanning source code for flaws.
363	DAST	<i>Dynamic analysis</i>	Testing a running app for flaws.
364	IAST	<i>Interactive analysis</i>	Testing from inside a running app.
365	SCA	<i>Dependency scan</i>	Checking third-party libraries for flaws.
366	Dependency	<i>Library</i>	Outside code your app relies on.
367	Software composition	<i>Component list</i>	All the parts making up an app.
368	SBOM	<i>Software bill of materials</i>	A full list of software components.
369	Secrets management	<i>Key handling</i>	Safely storing app passwords and keys.
370	Hardcoded secret	<i>Embedded key</i>	A password left inside source code.
371	Fuzzing	<i>Random testing</i>	Feeding junk input to find crashes.
372	Penetration test	<i>Pentest</i>	A hired hacker test of your defenses.
373	Bug bounty	<i>Reward program</i>	Paying outsiders to report flaws.
374	Responsible disclosure	<i>Coordinated disclosure</i>	Reporting flaws privately before public.
375	Threat modeling	<i>Risk mapping</i>	Planning what could attack an app.
376	Clickjack protection	<i>Frame guard</i>	Stopping hidden-click attacks.
377	Web scraping	<i>Data harvesting</i>	Auto-collecting data from websites.

CLOUD & VIRTUALIZATION

#	TERM	ALSO CALLED	SIMPLE MEANING
378	Cloud computing	<i>Rented servers</i>	Using computing over the internet.
379	Cloud security	<i>Cloud protection</i>	Securing data and apps in the cloud.
380	Shared responsibility	<i>Split duty</i>	Cloud provider and you each secure parts.
381	IaaS	<i>Infrastructure as a Service</i>	Renting raw servers and storage.
382	PaaS	<i>Platform as a Service</i>	Renting a ready platform to build on.
383	SaaS	<i>Software as a Service</i>	Using software over the web.
384	Public cloud	<i>Shared cloud</i>	Cloud shared by many customers.
385	Private cloud	<i>Dedicated cloud</i>	Cloud used by one organization.
386	Hybrid cloud	<i>Mixed cloud</i>	A blend of private and public cloud.
387	Multi-cloud	<i>Many providers</i>	Using several cloud providers at once.
388	Virtual machine	<i>VM</i>	A software-based computer.
389	Hypervisor	<i>VM manager</i>	Software that runs virtual machines.
390	Container	<i>App box</i>	A lightweight package of an app and its parts.

#	TERM	ALSO CALLED	SIMPLE MEANING
391	Kubernetes	<i>Container orchestrator</i>	A tool to run many containers.
392	Orchestration	<i>Auto-coordination</i>	Automating how systems work together.
393	Serverless	<i>Function cloud</i>	Running code without managing servers.
394	Function as a Service	<i>FaaS</i>	Running single functions on demand.
395	Cloud workload	<i>Cloud task</i>	Any app or job running in the cloud.
396	CSPM	<i>Cloud posture management</i>	Tools finding cloud misconfigurations.
397	CWPP	<i>Workload protection</i>	Tools protecting cloud workloads.
398	CASB	<i>Cloud access broker</i>	A gate controlling cloud app use.
399	CNAPP	<i>Cloud-native protection</i>	An all-in-one cloud security platform.
400	Cloud misconfiguration	<i>Bad cloud setup</i>	Weak cloud settings attackers exploit.
401	Bucket	<i>Storage box</i>	A cloud container for files.
402	Public bucket	<i>Open storage</i>	Cloud storage exposed to everyone.
403	IAM role	<i>Cloud role</i>	A set of cloud permissions for a task.
404	Instance	<i>Cloud server</i>	A single running cloud machine.
405	Snapshot	<i>Backup image</i>	A saved copy of a system's state.
406	Image	<i>Template</i>	A ready-made system to launch copies from.
407	Region	<i>Data zone</i>	A geographic cloud location.
408	Availability zone	<i>Data center group</i>	Isolated sites inside a region.
409	Elasticity	<i>Auto-scaling</i>	Growing or shrinking resources on demand.
410	Tenant	<i>Cloud customer</i>	One user of a shared cloud system.
411	Multi-tenancy	<i>Shared hosting</i>	Many customers on one system.
412	Ephemeral	<i>Short-lived</i>	Resources that exist only briefly.
413	Infrastructure as Code	<i>IaC</i>	Building systems from written config files.
414	Secrets store	<i>Cloud vault</i>	A cloud service holding keys and secrets.
415	Cloud-native	<i>Built-for-cloud</i>	Designed to run in the cloud from the start.
416	Edge computing	<i>Near-user compute</i>	Processing data close to where it's made.

ENDPOINT & DEVICE SECURITY

#	TERM	ALSO CALLED	SIMPLE MEANING
417	Endpoint	<i>End device</i>	Any device that connects to a network.
418	Endpoint security	<i>Device protection</i>	Securing laptops, phones and servers.
419	Antivirus	<i>AV</i>	Software that finds and removes malware.
420	Anti-malware	<i>Malware blocker</i>	Software that stops many malware types.
421	EDR	<i>Endpoint Detection and Response</i>	Advanced device threat detection tool.
422	XDR	<i>Extended Detection and Response</i>	Detection across devices, network and cloud.
423	MDR	<i>Managed Detection and Response</i>	Outsourced threat detection service.
424	Host firewall	<i>Device firewall</i>	A firewall built into one machine.
425	Sandbox	<i>Test cage</i>	A safe isolated space to run risky code.
426	Quarantine	<i>Isolation box</i>	Locking away a suspected malicious file.
427	Signature	<i>Malware fingerprint</i>	A known pattern used to spot malware.
428	Heuristics	<i>Behavior guess</i>	Spotting malware by suspicious behavior.
429	Behavioral analysis	<i>Action watching</i>	Judging software by what it does.
430	Whitelisting	<i>Allow-only</i>	Running only approved programs.
431	Application control	<i>App gate</i>	Deciding which apps may run.
432	Patch	<i>Fix update</i>	Code that repairs a flaw.
433	Patch management	<i>Update control</i>	Keeping software fixed and current.

#	TERM	ALSO CALLED	SIMPLE MEANING
434	Hotfix	<i>Quick fix</i>	A fast, small urgent patch.
435	Update	<i>Upgrade</i>	New software replacing old.
436	End-of-life	<i>EOL</i>	Software no longer supported or fixed.
437	BYOD	<i>Bring Your Own Device</i>	Using personal devices for work.
438	MDM	<i>Mobile Device Management</i>	Tools to control company phones.
439	UEM	<i>Unified Endpoint Management</i>	One tool to manage all devices.
440	Disk encryption	<i>Drive lock</i>	Encrypting a whole storage drive.
441	BitLocker	<i>Windows drive lock</i>	Microsoft's disk encryption tool.
442	Secure boot	<i>Trusted startup</i>	Ensuring only trusted code boots.
443	TPM	<i>Trusted Platform Module</i>	A chip that guards keys and boot integrity.
444	Firmware	<i>Chip software</i>	Low-level code built into hardware.
445	BIOS	<i>Startup firmware</i>	Basic code that starts a computer.
446	UEFI	<i>Modern BIOS</i>	The newer startup firmware standard.
447	Device driver	<i>Hardware bridge</i>	Software letting the OS use hardware.
448	USB blocking	<i>Port lock</i>	Stopping unknown USB devices.
449	Data Loss Prevention	<i>DLP</i>	Tools stopping data from leaking out.
450	Screen lock	<i>Auto-lock</i>	Locking a device after inactivity.
451	Remote wipe	<i>Erase-from-afar</i>	Deleting a lost device's data remotely.
452	Endpoint agent	<i>Local sensor</i>	Software on a device that reports to security.

TOOLS & SOFTWARE

#	TERM	ALSO CALLED	SIMPLE MEANING
453	Nmap	<i>Port scanner</i>	A tool to map networks and open ports.
454	Wireshark	<i>Packet analyzer</i>	A tool to capture and read network traffic.
455	Metasploit	<i>Exploit framework</i>	A toolkit to test exploits.
456	Burp Suite	<i>Web test tool</i>	A tool to test web app security.
457	Nessus	<i>Vuln scanner</i>	A tool that scans for known weaknesses.
458	OpenVAS	<i>Open vuln scanner</i>	A free vulnerability scanner.
459	Nikto	<i>Web scanner</i>	A tool that scans web servers for issues.
460	Hydra	<i>Login cracker</i>	A tool to brute-force logins.
461	John the Ripper	<i>Password cracker</i>	A tool to crack password hashes.
462	Hashcat	<i>GPU cracker</i>	A fast password-cracking tool.
463	Aircrack-ng	<i>Wi-Fi cracker</i>	A tool to test wireless security.
464	Kali Linux	<i>Hacker OS</i>	A Linux built for security testing.
465	Snort	<i>IDS engine</i>	An open intrusion detection tool.
466	Suricata	<i>Traffic IDS</i>	A high-speed intrusion detection engine.
467	Zeek	<i>Network monitor</i>	A tool for deep network analysis.
468	Sqlmap	<i>SQLi tool</i>	A tool that automates SQL injection tests.
469	Ndmap	<i>Recon tool</i>	A tool for network reconnaissance.
470	OSINT	<i>Open-source intel</i>	Info gathered from public sources.
471	Shodan	<i>Device search engine</i>	A search engine for internet devices.
472	Maltego	<i>Link mapper</i>	A tool to map relationships in data.
473	theHarvester	<i>Email finder</i>	A tool to gather emails and names.
474	Recon-ng	<i>Recon framework</i>	A framework for information gathering.
475	Cobalt Strike	<i>Red-team tool</i>	A commercial attack simulation tool (often abused).
476	Mimikatz	<i>Credential dumper</i>	A tool that steals Windows passwords.
477	BloodHound	<i>AD mapper</i>	A tool that maps Active Directory attack paths.

#	TERM	ALSO CALLED	SIMPLE MEANING
478	Autopsy	<i>Forensics tool</i>	A tool to investigate digital evidence.
479	Volatility	<i>Memory forensics</i>	A tool to analyze RAM dumps.
480	YARA	<i>Malware rules</i>	A tool to identify malware by patterns.
481	Sysmon	<i>System monitor</i>	A Windows tool logging detailed events.
482	OSQuery	<i>System query</i>	A tool to ask a device about its state.
483	Splunk	<i>Log platform</i>	A tool to search and analyze logs.
484	ELK Stack	<i>Log toolkit</i>	Elasticsearch, Logstash and Kibana together.
485	Wazuh	<i>Open SIEM</i>	A free security monitoring platform.
486	Nuclei	<i>Vuln templates</i>	A fast template-based vulnerability scanner.
487	Gobuster	<i>Path finder</i>	A tool to brute-force hidden web paths.
488	Ffuf	<i>Web fuzzer</i>	A fast web fuzzing tool.
489	Netcat	<i>Network tool</i>	A simple tool to read/write network data.
490	Tcpdump	<i>CLI sniffer</i>	A command-line packet capture tool.
491	Frida	<i>App hooker</i>	A tool to inspect running apps.
492	MobSF	<i>Mobile scanner</i>	A tool to test mobile app security.

PROTOCOLS

#	TERM	ALSO CALLED	SIMPLE MEANING
493	HTTP	<i>Web protocol</i>	Rules for browsers and web servers.
494	FTP	<i>File transfer</i>	An old protocol to move files.
495	SFTP	<i>Secure file transfer</i>	File transfer over SSH.
496	FTPS	<i>FTP with TLS</i>	FTP protected by TLS.
497	SSH	<i>Secure shell</i>	Encrypted remote command access.
498	Telnet	<i>Old remote shell</i>	Unencrypted remote access (unsafe).
499	SMTP	<i>Mail send</i>	Protocol for sending email.
500	IMAP	<i>Mail read</i>	Protocol for reading email on a server.
501	POP3	<i>Mail download</i>	Protocol for downloading email.
502	DNSSEC	<i>Signed DNS</i>	DNS with tamper protection.
503	SNMP	<i>Device monitor</i>	Protocol to manage network devices.
504	ICMP	<i>Ping protocol</i>	Used for network status messages.
505	ARP	<i>Address resolver</i>	Maps IP to hardware addresses.
506	NTP	<i>Time sync</i>	Keeps device clocks in sync.
507	RDP	<i>Remote desktop</i>	Protocol for remote screen control.
508	SMB	<i>File sharing</i>	Protocol to share files on a network.
509	IPsec	<i>IP security</i>	Encrypts network traffic at the IP layer.
510	RADIUS	<i>Login server protocol</i>	Central authentication for network access.
511	TACACS+	<i>Admin auth protocol</i>	Access control for network devices.
512	SCIM	<i>User sync</i>	Automates user account provisioning.
513	Syslog	<i>Log protocol</i>	A standard for sending system logs.
514	VoIP	<i>Internet calls</i>	Voice calls over the internet.
515	SIP	<i>Call setup</i>	Protocol that sets up VoIP calls.
516	MQTT	<i>IoT messaging</i>	A lightweight protocol for IoT devices.
517	BGP	<i>Route protocol</i>	Directs traffic between big networks.
518	QUIC	<i>Fast transport</i>	A modern quick, secure transport protocol.
519	WPA2-Enterprise	<i>Business Wi-Fi</i>	Wi-Fi security using a login server.
520	EAP	<i>Auth framework</i>	A flexible network authentication method.

COMPLIANCE & GOVERNANCE

#	TERM	ALSO CALLED	SIMPLE MEANING
521	Compliance	<i>Rule-following</i>	Meeting required security laws and rules.
522	Governance	<i>Oversight</i>	Directing and controlling security.
523	GRC	<i>Governance Risk Compliance</i>	Managing rules, risk and oversight together.
524	Policy	<i>Rulebook</i>	A formal statement of security rules.
525	Standard	<i>Fixed requirement</i>	A mandatory technical rule.
526	Procedure	<i>Step guide</i>	Exact steps to do a security task.
527	Guideline	<i>Advice</i>	Recommended, non-mandatory practices.
528	Framework	<i>Structure</i>	An organized set of security practices.
529	NIST CSF	<i>NIST framework</i>	A popular US cybersecurity framework.
530	ISO 27001	<i>Security standard</i>	A global standard for security management.
531	SOC 2	<i>Trust report</i>	An audit of a service's security controls.
532	PCI DSS	<i>Card standard</i>	Rules for handling payment card data.
533	HIPAA	<i>Health privacy law</i>	US law protecting health data.
534	GDPR	<i>EU privacy law</i>	EU law protecting personal data.
535	CCPA	<i>California privacy law</i>	California's data privacy law.
536	DPDP	<i>India privacy law</i>	India's data protection law.
537	Audit	<i>Formal check</i>	An independent review of controls.
538	Assessment	<i>Evaluation</i>	Judging how secure something is.
539	Gap analysis	<i>Shortfall check</i>	Comparing current state to a target.
540	Attestation	<i>Formal claim</i>	A signed statement that controls exist.
541	Risk assessment	<i>Risk study</i>	Finding and rating risks.
542	Risk register	<i>Risk list</i>	A recorded list of known risks.
543	Risk appetite	<i>Risk comfort</i>	How much risk an org accepts.
544	Risk treatment	<i>Risk handling</i>	Deciding how to deal with each risk.
545	Control objective	<i>Control goal</i>	What a control is meant to achieve.
546	Compensating control	<i>Backup control</i>	An alternate control when the ideal isn't possible.
547	Preventive control	<i>Blocker</i>	A control that stops incidents.
548	Detective control	<i>Alarm</i>	A control that spots incidents.
549	Corrective control	<i>Repairer</i>	A control that fixes after an incident.
550	Due diligence	<i>Homework</i>	Careful checking before a decision.
551	Due care	<i>Reasonable effort</i>	Taking sensible steps to protect assets.
552	Data classification	<i>Data labeling</i>	Ranking data by sensitivity.
553	Data retention	<i>Keep period</i>	How long data must be stored.
554	Chain of custody	<i>Evidence trail</i>	A record of who handled evidence.
555	Regulatory requirement	<i>Legal rule</i>	A rule set by law or regulators.
556	Third-party risk	<i>Vendor risk</i>	Risk from outside suppliers.
557	Vendor assessment	<i>Supplier check</i>	Judging a supplier's security.
558	Privacy impact assessment	<i>PIA</i>	A study of privacy risks in a project.
559	Business Impact Analysis	<i>BIA</i>	Judging the effect of losing a system.
560	Service Level Agreement	<i>SLA</i>	A promised level of service.

INCIDENT RESPONSE & FORENSICS

#	TERM	ALSO CALLED	SIMPLE MEANING
561	Incident response	<i>IR</i>	The plan to handle a security breach.
562	Playbook	<i>Response guide</i>	Step-by-step actions for an incident type.

#	TERM	ALSO CALLED	SIMPLE MEANING
563	Runbook	<i>Ops guide</i>	Detailed steps to run or fix a system.
564	Triage	<i>Sorting</i>	Ranking incidents by urgency.
565	Containment	<i>Stop-spread</i>	Limiting an incident's reach.
566	Eradication	<i>Removal</i>	Getting rid of the threat completely.
567	Recovery	<i>Restore</i>	Bringing systems back to normal.
568	Lessons learned	<i>Post-mortem</i>	Reviewing an incident to improve.
569	Root cause analysis	<i>RCA</i>	Finding the true source of a problem.
570	SOC	<i>Security Operations Center</i>	A team that watches for threats 24/7.
571	SIEM	<i>Log analyzer</i>	A tool that collects and correlates logs.
572	SOAR	<i>Auto-response</i>	A tool that automates security actions.
573	Alert	<i>Warning</i>	A signal that something may be wrong.
574	Alert fatigue	<i>Warning overload</i>	Too many alerts to handle well.
575	False positive	<i>False alarm</i>	An alert with no real threat.
576	False negative	<i>Missed threat</i>	A real threat that wasn't detected.
577	True positive	<i>Correct alert</i>	A real threat correctly flagged.
578	Correlation	<i>Linking clues</i>	Combining events to spot an attack.
579	Log	<i>Record</i>	A saved list of system events.
580	Log aggregation	<i>Log gathering</i>	Collecting logs into one place.
581	Threat hunting	<i>Proactive search</i>	Actively looking for hidden threats.
582	Threat intelligence	<i>Threat intel</i>	Knowledge about current attackers.
583	Feed	<i>Data stream</i>	A live source of threat data.
584	Digital forensics	<i>Cyber CSI</i>	Investigating digital evidence.
585	Forensic image	<i>Bit copy</i>	An exact copy of a drive for analysis.
586	Memory dump	<i>RAM copy</i>	A snapshot of a system's memory.
587	Artifact	<i>Digital trace</i>	A leftover piece of evidence.
588	Timeline analysis	<i>Event ordering</i>	Reconstructing what happened, when.
589	Volatile data	<i>Fleeting data</i>	Data lost when power is off (like RAM).
590	Write blocker	<i>Read-only tool</i>	A device that stops changing evidence.
591	Anti-forensics	<i>Trace hiding</i>	Techniques to defeat investigators.
592	Malware analysis	<i>Malware study</i>	Examining malware to understand it.
593	Static analysis	<i>Code-off study</i>	Studying malware without running it.
594	Dynamic analysis	<i>Run study</i>	Studying malware while it runs.
595	Reverse engineering	<i>Teardown</i>	Taking software apart to understand it.
596	Disaster recovery	<i>DR</i>	Restoring IT after a major failure.
597	Business continuity	<i>BCP</i>	Keeping the business running through disruption.
598	Backup	<i>Data copy</i>	A spare copy for restoring data.
599	Immutable backup	<i>Locked backup</i>	A backup that can't be changed or deleted.
600	Recovery Time Objective	<i>RTO</i>	Target time to restore a system.
601	Recovery Point Objective	<i>RPO</i>	How much data loss is acceptable.
602	Tabletop exercise	<i>Practice drill</i>	A talk-through rehearsal of an incident.
603	Escalation	<i>Hand-up</i>	Raising an issue to higher responders.

PEOPLE & ROLES

#	TERM	ALSO CALLED	SIMPLE MEANING
604	Hacker	<i>Cyber intruder</i>	Someone who breaks into systems.
605	Black hat	<i>Criminal hacker</i>	A malicious, illegal hacker.
606	White hat	<i>Ethical hacker</i>	A hacker who helps improve security.

#	TERM	ALSO CALLED	SIMPLE MEANING
607	Gray hat	<i>In-between hacker</i>	A hacker who bends rules without clear malice.
608	Script kiddie	<i>Novice attacker</i>	An unskilled attacker using others' tools.
609	Hacktivist	<i>Cause hacker</i>	A hacker driven by a political cause.
610	Nation-state actor	<i>State hacker</i>	A government-backed attacker.
611	Advanced Persistent Threat	<i>APT</i>	A skilled, patient, long-term attacker group.
612	Cybercriminal	<i>Online crook</i>	A person committing crimes online.
613	Ethical hacker	<i>Pentester</i>	A hired hacker who tests defenses legally.
614	Red team	<i>Attack team</i>	Testers who simulate real attackers.
615	Blue team	<i>Defense team</i>	Defenders who protect and respond.
616	Purple team	<i>Blend team</i>	Red and blue working together.
617	Security analyst	<i>SOC analyst</i>	A person who watches and investigates alerts.
618	Threat hunter	<i>Proactive defender</i>	Someone who searches for hidden threats.
619	Incident responder	<i>First responder</i>	A person who handles active breaches.
620	Security engineer	<i>Builder</i>	Someone who builds security systems.
621	Security architect	<i>Designer</i>	Someone who designs secure systems.
622	CISO	<i>Security chief</i>	The top security executive.
623	Compliance officer	<i>Rule keeper</i>	Someone ensuring rules are met.
624	Forensic analyst	<i>Cyber investigator</i>	Someone examining digital evidence.
625	Malware analyst	<i>Malware researcher</i>	Someone who studies malicious code.
626	Bug bounty hunter	<i>Flaw finder</i>	Someone paid to report security bugs.
627	Insider	<i>Trusted user</i>	Someone inside the organization.
628	Data Protection Officer	<i>DPO</i>	Someone overseeing privacy compliance.
629	Vulnerability researcher	<i>Flaw hunter</i>	Someone who discovers new weaknesses.

DATA & PRIVACY

#	TERM	ALSO CALLED	SIMPLE MEANING
630	Data privacy	<i>Info privacy</i>	Keeping personal data under control.
631	Personal data	<i>PII</i>	Info identifying a specific person.
632	PII	<i>Personal info</i>	Personally Identifiable Information.
633	PHI	<i>Health info</i>	Protected Health Information.
634	Sensitive data	<i>Critical info</i>	Data that would cause harm if leaked.
635	Anonymization	<i>De-identifying</i>	Removing identity from data permanently.
636	Pseudonymization	<i>Masking IDs</i>	Replacing identifiers with fake ones.
637	Tokenization	<i>Value swap</i>	Replacing sensitive data with safe tokens.
638	Data masking	<i>Data hiding</i>	Hiding parts of data (e.g. card digits).
639	Redaction	<i>Blacking out</i>	Permanently removing sensitive text.
640	Data minimization	<i>Collect less</i>	Keeping only the data truly needed.
641	Consent	<i>Permission</i>	A user's agreement to use their data.
642	Data subject	<i>Data owner</i>	The person a piece of data is about.
643	Data controller	<i>Data decider</i>	Who decides why data is processed.
644	Data processor	<i>Data handler</i>	Who processes data for a controller.
645	Right to erasure	<i>Right to be forgotten</i>	A user's right to have data deleted.
646	Data breach notification	<i>Breach alert</i>	Telling people their data was exposed.
647	Data sovereignty	<i>Local data law</i>	Data ruled by the laws of its location.
648	Data residency	<i>Data location</i>	Where data is physically stored.
649	Data lifecycle	<i>Data journey</i>	Data from creation to deletion.

#	TERM	ALSO CALLED	SIMPLE MEANING
650	Data at rest	<i>Stored data</i>	Data saved on a disk or database.
651	Data in transit	<i>Moving data</i>	Data traveling across a network.
652	Data in use	<i>Active data</i>	Data being processed in memory.
653	Data leakage	<i>Slow leak</i>	Data slipping out unintentionally.
654	Exfiltration	<i>Data smuggling</i>	Stealing data out of a system.
655	Data integrity	<i>Data correctness</i>	Ensuring data isn't secretly changed.
656	Checksum	<i>Integrity check</i>	A value confirming data is unchanged.
657	Data governance	<i>Data rules</i>	Managing data quality and access.
658	Privacy by design	<i>Built-in privacy</i>	Adding privacy from the start.

MOBILE & IOT SECURITY

#	TERM	ALSO CALLED	SIMPLE MEANING
659	Mobile security	<i>Phone security</i>	Protecting phones and their data.
660	IoT	<i>Internet of Things</i>	Everyday devices connected online.
661	IoT security	<i>Device security</i>	Protecting connected smart devices.
662	Rooting	<i>Android unlock</i>	Gaining full control of an Android phone.
663	Jailbreaking	<i>iOS unlock</i>	Removing Apple's restrictions on an iPhone.
664	Sideloading	<i>Off-store install</i>	Installing apps from outside official stores.
665	App sandbox	<i>App cage</i>	Isolation keeping apps from each other.
666	App permission	<i>Access grant</i>	What an app is allowed to use.
667	Overprivileged app	<i>Greedy app</i>	An app asking for more access than needed.
668	SMS phishing	<i>Smishing</i>	Phishing over text messages.
669	SIM swapping	<i>SIM hijack</i>	Stealing a phone number to grab codes.
670	IMSI catcher	<i>Fake tower</i>	A fake cell tower that spies on phones.
671	Man-in-the-Middle mobile	<i>Mobile MITM</i>	Intercepting a phone's traffic.
672	Certificate pinning	<i>Cert lock</i>	Forcing an app to trust only set certificates.
673	Root detection	<i>Tamper check</i>	An app checking if a phone is rooted.
674	Mobile DLP	<i>Phone data guard</i>	Stopping data leaks from phones.
675	Wearable security	<i>Gadget security</i>	Protecting smartwatches and bands.
676	Firmware update	<i>Device patch</i>	Fixing bugs in device firmware.
677	Default credentials	<i>Factory password</i>	Preset logins left unchanged (risky).
678	Botnet of things	<i>IoT botnet</i>	Hijacked smart devices used to attack.
679	OTA update	<i>Over-the-air update</i>	Updating a device wirelessly.
680	Edge device	<i>Field device</i>	A device at the network's outer edge.
681	Smart home risk	<i>Home IoT risk</i>	Weaknesses in home smart devices.
682	Bluetooth attack	<i>BT attack</i>	Exploiting Bluetooth connections.
683	Pairing	<i>Device linking</i>	Connecting two devices to trust each other.

AI & EMERGING SECURITY

#	TERM	ALSO CALLED	SIMPLE MEANING
684	AI security	<i>Machine security</i>	Protecting AI systems from misuse and attack.
685	Adversarial attack	<i>AI fooling</i>	Tricking an AI with crafted input.
686	Adversarial example	<i>Trick input</i>	Input designed to fool an AI model.
687	Data poisoning	<i>Training poison</i>	Corrupting an AI's training data.
688	Model poisoning	<i>Model tampering</i>	Secretly corrupting an AI model.
689	Jailbreak	<i>Guardrail bypass</i>	Tricking an AI past its safety rules.
690	Model inversion	<i>Data recovery attack</i>	Extracting training data from a model.
691	Membership inference	<i>Data guess</i>	Guessing if data was used to train a model.

#	TERM	ALSO CALLED	SIMPLE MEANING
692	Model extraction	<i>Model theft</i>	Copying a model by probing it.
693	Hallucination	<i>AI making-up</i>	When an AI states false things confidently.
694	Guardrails	<i>Safety limits</i>	Rules that keep an AI safe and on-task.
695	Red teaming AI	<i>AI stress test</i>	Attacking an AI to find its flaws.
696	Alignment	<i>Goal matching</i>	Making AI act as intended and safely.
697	Training data	<i>Learning data</i>	The data an AI learns from.
698	Inference	<i>AI prediction</i>	When a trained AI produces an answer.
699	LLM	<i>Large Language Model</i>	An AI trained on huge amounts of text.
700	RAG	<i>Retrieval-augmented AI</i>	AI that looks up facts before answering.
701	Shadow AI	<i>Unapproved AI</i>	AI tools used without security approval.
702	Model card	<i>AI spec sheet</i>	A document describing an AI model.
703	Watermarking AI	<i>AI marking</i>	Hidden marks proving content is AI-made.
704	Data leakage AI	<i>Model leak</i>	An AI revealing its private training data.
705	Supply chain AI	<i>Model provenance</i>	Tracking where AI models and data come from.
706	Deepfake detection	<i>Fake spotting</i>	Tools that detect AI-faked media.
707	Sensitive output filtering	<i>Output guard</i>	Blocking harmful AI responses.

GENERAL & OPERATIONS

#	TERM	ALSO CALLED	SIMPLE MEANING
708	Access	<i>Entry</i>	The ability to use a system or data.
709	Account	<i>User profile</i>	A named identity for using a system.
710	Admin	<i>Administrator</i>	A high-power user account.
711	Agent	<i>Local software</i>	A small program that runs on a device.
712	Alert triage	<i>Alert sorting</i>	Ranking alerts to handle first.
713	Anomaly	<i>Oddity</i>	Something outside the normal pattern.
714	Anomaly detection	<i>Odd-spotting</i>	Finding activity that breaks the norm.
715	Antispam	<i>Junk blocker</i>	Software that blocks unwanted email.
716	Application	<i>App</i>	A software program for a task.
717	Approval workflow	<i>Sign-off flow</i>	A required chain of approvals.
718	Assurance	<i>Confidence</i>	Evidence that controls truly work.
719	Attribution	<i>Blame tracing</i>	Identifying who did an attack.
720	Awareness training	<i>Security training</i>	Teaching staff to stay secure.
721	Backdoor account	<i>Hidden account</i>	A secret account for later access.
722	Bandwidth throttling	<i>Speed limiting</i>	Slowing traffic on purpose.
723	Behavioral biometrics	<i>Habit login</i>	Identifying users by their behavior.
724	Blocklisting	<i>Denylisting</i>	Blocking known-bad items.
725	Boot sector	<i>Startup area</i>	The disk part that starts a computer.
726	Bring your own key	<i>BYOK</i>	Using your own encryption keys in the cloud.
727	Brute-forcing	<i>Guess attack</i>	Trying all combinations to break in.
728	Certificate revocation	<i>Cert cancel</i>	Marking a certificate as no longer valid.
729	CRL	<i>Revocation list</i>	A list of canceled certificates.
730	OCSP	<i>Cert status check</i>	A live check if a certificate is valid.
731	Cipher suite	<i>Encryption set</i>	The chosen mix of encryption methods.
732	Cleartext	<i>Unencrypted</i>	Data with no encryption.
733	Cloud broker	<i>Access gate</i>	A control point for cloud services.
734	Command injection point	<i>Weak input</i>	A spot where commands can be injected.
735	Compliance audit	<i>Rule check</i>	A formal review of rule-following.

#	TERM	ALSO CALLED	SIMPLE MEANING
736	Configuration drift	<i>Setting slip</i>	Settings slowly changing from the baseline.
737	Container escape	<i>Box breakout</i>	Breaking out of a container to the host.
738	Credential harvesting	<i>Login collecting</i>	Mass-stealing login details.
739	Cyber hygiene	<i>Basic habits</i>	Everyday steps that keep you secure.
740	Cyber insurance	<i>Breach insurance</i>	Insurance covering cyber losses.
741	Cyber range	<i>Practice lab</i>	A safe arena to practice defense.
742	Cyber resilience	<i>Bounce-back</i>	Ability to keep going despite attacks.
743	Dark web	<i>Hidden internet</i>	Hidden sites often used for crime.
744	Deep web	<i>Unindexed web</i>	Web pages search engines don't list.
745	Decommissioning	<i>Retiring</i>	Safely shutting down old systems.
746	Defacement	<i>Site vandalism</i>	Attackers altering a website's look.
747	Detection rule	<i>Alert rule</i>	Logic that triggers a security alert.
748	Digital footprint	<i>Online trail</i>	The data trail a person leaves online.
749	Disaster recovery site	<i>Backup site</i>	A spare location to run systems.
750	Domain	<i>Network group</i>	A managed group of systems or a web name.
751	Endpoint hardening	<i>Device locking</i>	Tightening a device's settings.
752	Enumeration attack	<i>Listing attack</i>	Discovering valid users or resources.
753	Evasion	<i>Detection dodging</i>	Avoiding security tools.
754	Exploit chain	<i>Combo attack</i>	Linking several exploits together.
755	Exposure management	<i>Weakness tracking</i>	Managing all reachable weaknesses.
756	Federated identity	<i>Shared login</i>	One identity trusted across systems.
757	File integrity monitoring	<i>FIM</i>	Watching files for unexpected changes.
758	Firewall rule	<i>Traffic rule</i>	One instruction telling a firewall what to allow.
759	Golden image	<i>Master template</i>	A trusted base system to clone.
760	Hardening guide	<i>Lockdown guide</i>	Instructions to secure a system.
761	Hash function	<i>Digest maker</i>	Math that turns data into a fixed code.
762	Host	<i>Machine</i>	A single computer on a network.
763	Identity theft	<i>ID theft</i>	Stealing someone's identity for gain.
764	Incident ticket	<i>Case record</i>	A tracked record of an incident.
765	Insider risk	<i>Trusted risk</i>	Danger from people inside the org.
766	Integrity check	<i>Tamper check</i>	Verifying data hasn't changed.
767	Intrusion	<i>Break-in</i>	Unauthorized entry into a system.
768	Isolation	<i>Separation</i>	Keeping a threat away from other systems.
769	Jump server	<i>Access hub</i>	A controlled server to reach secure zones.
770	Key management	<i>Key control</i>	Handling encryption keys safely.
771	Kill switch	<i>Emergency stop</i>	A control to instantly shut something down.
772	Known-good	<i>Trusted state</i>	A verified safe version to compare to.
773	Log retention	<i>Log keeping</i>	How long logs are stored.
774	Log tampering	<i>Log editing</i>	Secretly altering logs to hide tracks.
775	Malicious insider	<i>Rogue staff</i>	An insider who intends harm.
776	Managed service provider	<i>MSP</i>	A company running IT for others.
777	MSSP	<i>Managed security provider</i>	A company running security for others.
778	Network scanning	<i>Network probing</i>	Checking a network for live hosts.
779	Obfuscated code	<i>Hidden code</i>	Code deliberately made unreadable.
780	Offboarding	<i>Exit process</i>	Removing access when someone leaves.
781	Onboarding	<i>Entry process</i>	Setting up access for new staff.

#	TERM	ALSO CALLED	SIMPLE MEANING
782	Out-of-band	<i>Separate channel</i>	A different path used for safety.
783	Patch Tuesday	<i>Update day</i>	Microsoft's monthly patch release day.
784	Perimeter	<i>Boundary</i>	The outer edge of a protected network.
785	Persistence	<i>Foothold</i>	How malware survives reboots.
786	Phishing simulation	<i>Fake-phish test</i>	A safe test phishing email for staff.
787	Physical security	<i>Site security</i>	Protecting buildings and hardware.
788	Principle of least privilege	<i>Minimal rights</i>	Give only the access needed.
789	Privilege creep	<i>Access buildup</i>	Users slowly gaining extra rights.
790	Proof of concept	<i>PoC</i>	A demo showing an exploit works.
791	Quarantine network	<i>Holding zone</i>	A restricted area for risky devices.
792	Recon	<i>Scouting</i>	Gathering info before an attack.
793	Red flag	<i>Warning sign</i>	A hint that something is wrong.
794	Remediation plan	<i>Fix plan</i>	Steps to correct found weaknesses.
795	Replay protection	<i>Repeat guard</i>	Stopping reused data from working.
796	Rogue device	<i>Unknown device</i>	An unauthorized device on the network.
797	Sandboxing	<i>Caging</i>	Running code in a safe isolated space.
798	Scanning	<i>Probing</i>	Automatically checking for issues.
799	Secure by default	<i>Safe out-of-box</i>	Ships with strong settings enabled.
800	Secure channel	<i>Protected link</i>	An encrypted communication path.
801	Secure erase	<i>Wipe</i>	Permanently destroying data.
802	Security awareness	<i>Staff alertness</i>	How well staff spot threats.
803	Security champion	<i>Team advocate</i>	A developer who promotes security.
804	Security gateway	<i>Guard point</i>	A device filtering traffic at a boundary.
805	Security incident	<i>Breach event</i>	Any event harming security.
806	Security operations	<i>SecOps</i>	The daily work of defending systems.
807	Segregation	<i>Separation</i>	Keeping systems or duties apart.
808	Shadow IT	<i>Hidden tech</i>	Tech used without IT's approval.
809	Signature-based detection	<i>Pattern matching</i>	Spotting threats by known patterns.
810	Single point of failure	<i>SPOF</i>	One part whose failure breaks everything.
811	Smart card	<i>Chip card</i>	A card holding login credentials.
812	Spoofed email	<i>Fake email</i>	Email forged to look genuine.
813	Spam	<i>Junk mail</i>	Unwanted bulk messages.
814	Stateful inspection	<i>Connection tracking</i>	Watching whole connections for safety.
815	Threat feed	<i>Threat stream</i>	A live source of attacker data.
816	Time-to-detect	<i>Detection speed</i>	How fast a threat is noticed.
817	Time-to-respond	<i>Response speed</i>	How fast a threat is handled.
818	Tokenized data	<i>Swapped data</i>	Data replaced by safe placeholders.
819	Traffic shaping	<i>Flow control</i>	Managing network traffic priority.
820	Trust boundary	<i>Trust edge</i>	Where trust level changes in a system.
821	Two-person rule	<i>Dual control</i>	Two people needed for a risky action.
822	Unauthorized access	<i>Illegal entry</i>	Getting in without permission.
823	Uptime	<i>Availability time</i>	How long a system stays running.
824	Vulnerability disclosure	<i>Flaw report</i>	Reporting a weakness to be fixed.
825	Vulnerability management	<i>Weakness control</i>	Finding and fixing weaknesses over time.
826	Vulnerability scan	<i>Weakness check</i>	An automated search for known flaws.
827	Whitelisted app	<i>Approved app</i>	An app cleared to run.

#	TERM	ALSO CALLED	SIMPLE MEANING
828	Wiping	<i>Erasing</i>	Destroying data so it can't return.
829	Zero-day exploit	<i>Fresh exploit</i>	An attack using an unknown, unpatched flaw.
830	Zombie	<i>Bot host</i>	An infected machine under remote control.
831	Zone	<i>Segment</i>	A separated part of a network.
832	Threat surface	<i>Exposure area</i>	All points open to attack.
833	Security debt	<i>Neglect backlog</i>	Piled-up unfixed security problems.
834	Canary token	<i>Trap token</i>	A fake secret that alerts if used.
835	Decoy	<i>Bait</i>	A fake target to lure attackers.
836	Beaconing	<i>Check-in traffic</i>	Regular signals from malware to its owner.
837	Data enclave	<i>Safe zone</i>	A tightly controlled data area.
838	Break-glass account	<i>Emergency login</i>	A sealed account used only in crises.
839	Session timeout	<i>Auto-logout</i>	Ending idle sessions automatically.
840	Secure wipe	<i>Full erase</i>	Overwriting data so it's unrecoverable.
841	Threat actor group	<i>Crew</i>	A named team of attackers.
842	Watchlist	<i>Monitor list</i>	Items flagged for close watching.
843	Smurf attack	<i>Ping flood</i>	Flooding a victim using broadcast pings.
844	Fraggle attack	<i>UDP flood</i>	A Smurf-style flood using UDP packets.
845	Teardrop attack	<i>Fragment attack</i>	Crashing systems with broken packet fragments.
846	Ping of death	<i>Oversized ping</i>	Crashing a system with a huge ping packet.
847	SYN flood	<i>Half-open flood</i>	Overloading a server with fake connection starts.
848	Slowloris	<i>Slow flood</i>	Holding many connections open to stall a server.
849	HTTP flood	<i>Web flood</i>	Overwhelming a site with fake requests.
850	Zip bomb	<i>Decompression bomb</i>	A tiny file that explodes into huge data.
851	Fork bomb	<i>Process bomb</i>	Code that multiplies to crash a system.
852	Cache poisoning	<i>Cache trick</i>	Filling a cache with false data.
853	Cookie poisoning	<i>Cookie tampering</i>	Editing cookies to fool a site.
854	Parameter tampering	<i>Value editing</i>	Changing hidden values to abuse an app.
855	HTTP response splitting	<i>Header injection</i>	Injecting fake headers into responses.
856	Host header injection	<i>Header trick</i>	Abusing the Host header to redirect users.
857	Open redirect	<i>Redirect abuse</i>	Tricking a site into sending users to a bad link.
858	Subdomain takeover	<i>Orphan hijack</i>	Claiming an abandoned subdomain.
859	Credential replay	<i>Reused login</i>	Replaying stolen login data.
860	Pass-the-hash	<i>Hash reuse</i>	Logging in with a stolen password hash.
861	Pass-the-ticket	<i>Ticket reuse</i>	Reusing a stolen Kerberos ticket.
862	Golden ticket	<i>Master ticket</i>	A forged, all-powerful Kerberos ticket.
863	Silver ticket	<i>Service ticket forge</i>	A forged ticket for one service.
864	Kerberoasting	<i>Ticket cracking</i>	Cracking service passwords from Kerberos tickets.
865	DLL injection	<i>Code injection</i>	Forcing a program to load malicious code.
866	Process hollowing	<i>Ghost process</i>	Hiding malware inside a real process.
867	Return-oriented programming	<i>ROP</i>	Reusing existing code snippets to run an attack.
868	Heap spray	<i>Memory flooding</i>	Filling memory to make an exploit reliable.
869	Use-after-free	<i>Freed-memory bug</i>	Abusing memory that was already released.
870	Integer overflow	<i>Number wrap</i>	A math error attackers exploit.
871	Format string attack	<i>Printf bug</i>	Abusing text formatting to read or write memory.
872	Side-channel attack	<i>Leak-by-hint</i>	Stealing secrets from timing or power clues.
873	Timing attack	<i>Clock leak</i>	Guessing secrets from how long things take.
874	Cold boot attack	<i>Frozen RAM attack</i>	Reading memory from a just-powered-off machine.

#	TERM	ALSO CALLED	SIMPLE MEANING
875	Rowhammer	<i>Bit-flip attack</i>	Flipping memory bits by hammering nearby cells.
876	Spectre	<i>CPU leak</i>	A processor flaw leaking memory across programs.
877	Meltdown	<i>CPU boundary leak</i>	A processor flaw exposing protected memory.
878	Evil maid attack	<i>Tamper attack</i>	Physically tampering with an unattended device.
879	Juice jacking	<i>USB charge attack</i>	Malware spread through public charging ports.
880	BadUSB	<i>Rogue USB</i>	A USB device that acts as a malicious keyboard.
881	RFID cloning	<i>Tag copying</i>	Copying an access card's wireless chip.
882	NFC relay	<i>Tap relay</i>	Relaying contactless signals to steal access.
883	GPS spoofing	<i>Location faking</i>	Sending fake GPS signals.
884	Jamming	<i>Signal blocking</i>	Drowning out wireless signals.
885	War dialing	<i>Number scanning</i>	Auto-dialing numbers to find systems.
886	Banner grabbing	<i>Service reading</i>	Reading service info from responses.
887	Google dorking	<i>Search hacking</i>	Using clever searches to find exposed data.
888	Credential dumping	<i>Secret extraction</i>	Pulling stored passwords from a system.
889	Token theft	<i>Session steal</i>	Stealing access tokens to impersonate users.
890	Consent phishing	<i>OAuth phishing</i>	Tricking users into granting app access.
891	Malicious app	<i>Rogue app</i>	An app built to harm or spy.
892	Fake update	<i>Trojan update</i>	Malware disguised as a software update.
893	Bastion	<i>Guard host</i>	A hardened access point to secure zones.
894	Canary	<i>Early warning</i>	A tripwire that signals an intrusion.
895	Deception technology	<i>Trap tech</i>	Fake assets built to catch intruders.
896	Moving target defense	<i>Shifting defense</i>	Constantly changing to confuse attackers.
897	Threat emulation	<i>Attack mimicry</i>	Safely copying real attacks to test defenses.
898	Breach and attack simulation	<i>BAS</i>	Automated, continuous attack testing.
899	Attack path	<i>Route</i>	The chain of steps to reach a target.
900	Attack graph	<i>Path map</i>	A map of possible attack routes.
901	Security orchestration	<i>Coordination</i>	Linking security tools to act together.
902	Playbook automation	<i>Auto-steps</i>	Auto-running incident response steps.
903	Enrichment	<i>Context adding</i>	Adding detail to an alert for clarity.
904	Dwell time	<i>Hidden time</i>	How long an attacker stays undetected.
905	Mean time to detect	<i>MTTD</i>	Average time to notice a threat.
906	Mean time to respond	<i>MTTR</i>	Average time to react to a threat.
907	Baseline behavior	<i>Normal pattern</i>	The usual activity used for comparison.
908	User behavior analytics	<i>UBA</i>	Spotting threats by unusual user activity.
909	UEBA	<i>Entity analytics</i>	Behavior analytics for users and devices.
910	Risk score	<i>Danger rating</i>	A number showing how risky something is.
911	Confidence score	<i>Certainty rating</i>	How sure a tool is about a finding.
912	Severity	<i>Seriousness</i>	How bad an issue or alert is.
913	CVSS	<i>Severity score</i>	A standard 0-10 score for vulnerabilities.
914	CVE	<i>Flaw ID</i>	A public ID for a known vulnerability.
915	CWE	<i>Weakness type</i>	A category label for a kind of flaw.
916	CPE	<i>Product ID</i>	A standard name for a software product.
917	Patch gap	<i>Fix delay</i>	Time between a fix release and its install.
918	Exposure window	<i>Risk window</i>	The time a weakness stays open.
919	Attack simulation	<i>Drill</i>	A rehearsed fake attack for practice.
920	Purple teaming	<i>Joint testing</i>	Attackers and defenders improving together.
921	Tabletop	<i>Discussion drill</i>	A talk-through incident rehearsal.

#	TERM	ALSO CALLED	SIMPLE MEANING
922	Runtime protection	<i>Live defense</i>	Blocking attacks while software runs.
923	Memory protection	<i>RAM guard</i>	Stopping code from abusing memory.
924	Control plane	<i>Management layer</i>	Where a system is configured and controlled.
925	Data plane	<i>Traffic layer</i>	Where actual data moves through a system.
926	Trust store	<i>Cert store</i>	Where a system keeps trusted certificates.
927	Certificate transparency	<i>Cert logging</i>	Public logs of issued certificates.
928	Mutual TLS	<i>mTLS</i>	Both sides prove identity with certificates.
929	Federated login	<i>Shared sign-in</i>	Logging in via a trusted outside provider.
930	Passkey	<i>FIDO login</i>	A phishing-resistant passwordless credential.
931	FIDO2	<i>Strong auth standard</i>	A standard for passwordless, secure login.
932	WebAuthn	<i>Browser auth</i>	A web standard for passwordless login.
933	Attestation key	<i>Proof key</i>	A key proving a device is genuine.
934	Secure element	<i>Chip vault</i>	A tamper-resistant chip storing secrets.
935	Enclave	<i>Protected zone</i>	An isolated area for sensitive processing.
936	Confidential computing	<i>In-use encryption</i>	Protecting data even while it's processed.
937	Homomorphic encryption	<i>Compute-on-cipher</i>	Doing math on data without decrypting it.
938	Zero-knowledge proof	<i>Secret proof</i>	Proving something true without revealing it.
939	Key derivation function	<i>KDF</i>	Turning a password into a strong key.
940	PBKDF2	<i>Slow hash</i>	A method to make password cracking slow.
941	bcrypt	<i>Password hash</i>	A slow, salted password hashing method.
942	Argon2	<i>Modern hash</i>	A strong, memory-hard password hash.
943	Certificate signing request	<i>CSR</i>	A request asking a CA to issue a certificate.
944	Wildcard certificate	<i>Multi-sub cert</i>	A certificate covering all subdomains.
945	Revocation	<i>Cancellation</i>	Marking a key or certificate as invalid.
946	Trust chain	<i>Trust ladder</i>	The linked certificates proving trust.
947	Security policy	<i>Rule set</i>	The official rules for staying secure.
948	Acceptable use policy	<i>AUP</i>	Rules for how staff may use systems.
949	Change management	<i>Change control</i>	A process for safe system changes.
950	Configuration management	<i>Config control</i>	Tracking and controlling system settings.
951	Asset inventory	<i>Asset list</i>	A full list of owned devices and software.
952	Asset management	<i>Asset tracking</i>	Tracking all valuable systems and data.
953	CMDB	<i>Config database</i>	A database of all IT assets and links.
954	Data flow diagram	<i>DFD</i>	A map of how data moves through a system.
955	Threat register	<i>Threat list</i>	A recorded list of known threats.
956	Control framework	<i>Control set</i>	An organized list of security controls.
957	Maturity model	<i>Growth scale</i>	A scale rating how developed security is.
958	Key performance indicator	<i>KPI</i>	A number tracking security performance.
959	Key risk indicator	<i>KRI</i>	A number warning that risk is rising.
960	Security metrics	<i>Score tracking</i>	Numbers measuring security health.
961	Continuous monitoring	<i>Always watching</i>	Constantly checking systems for issues.
962	Continuous compliance	<i>Always compliant</i>	Staying rule-compliant at all times.
963	Segregation of duties	<i>Split roles</i>	Splitting tasks so no one has full power.
964	Data steward	<i>Data caretaker</i>	A person responsible for data quality.

#	TERM	ALSO CALLED	SIMPLE MEANING
965	Records management	<i>Record keeping</i>	Controlling how records are stored and kept.
966	Legal hold	<i>Preserve order</i>	A rule to keep data for a legal case.
967	eDiscovery	<i>Legal search</i>	Finding electronic data for legal cases.
968	Whistleblower	<i>Reporter</i>	Someone reporting wrongdoing internally.
969	Security clearance	<i>Access level</i>	Approved permission to see secret data.
970	Need to know	<i>Info limit</i>	Access only to info required for a job.
971	Background check	<i>Vetting</i>	Screening a person before granting trust.
972	Nondisclosure agreement	<i>NDA</i>	A contract to keep information secret.
973	Threat vector map	<i>Vector list</i>	All the routes threats can take.
974	Exploit database	<i>Exploit-DB</i>	A public archive of known exploits.
975	Vulnerability database	<i>Flaw archive</i>	A public store of known weaknesses.
976	Patch level	<i>Update state</i>	How up-to-date a system's fixes are.
977	Golden config	<i>Ideal setup</i>	The approved perfect configuration.
978	Drift detection	<i>Change spotting</i>	Noticing when settings stray from baseline.
979	Secure SDLC	<i>Safe build cycle</i>	Building security into every dev stage.
980	Shift left	<i>Early security</i>	Adding security early in development.
981	DevSecOps	<i>Security in DevOps</i>	Blending security into fast development.
982	CI/CD security	<i>Pipeline security</i>	Securing the automated build pipeline.
983	Artifact signing	<i>Build signing</i>	Proving a build wasn't tampered with.
984	Provenance	<i>Origin proof</i>	Verified history of where something came from.
985	Immutable infrastructure	<i>Replace-not-patch</i>	Systems replaced whole instead of edited.
986	Blue-green deployment	<i>Swap deploy</i>	Switching between two live environments safely.
987	Chaos engineering	<i>Break testing</i>	Breaking systems on purpose to test resilience.
988	Observability	<i>See-inside</i>	Being able to understand a system's inner state.
989	Telemetry	<i>Sensor data</i>	Data streamed from systems for monitoring.
990	Log source	<i>Event origin</i>	Where a log entry comes from.
991	Normalization	<i>Format matching</i>	Making logs share one common format.
992	Parsing	<i>Breaking down</i>	Splitting raw data into usable fields.
993	Retention policy	<i>Keep rule</i>	How long data or logs are stored.
994	Data broker	<i>Info seller</i>	A company that buys and sells personal data.
995	Threat actor profile	<i>Attacker dossier</i>	A summary of an attacker's habits.
996	Campaign	<i>Attack wave</i>	A coordinated set of related attacks.
997	Watchtower	<i>Monitor</i>	A system that watches for danger.
998	Sinkholing	<i>Traffic trap</i>	Redirecting malicious traffic to a dead end.
999	Takedown	<i>Removal</i>	Shutting down malicious infrastructure.
1000	Blocklist feed	<i>Bad-IP list</i>	A live list of known malicious addresses.
1001	Reputation service	<i>Trust rating</i>	A service rating IPs or domains by risk.
1002	Sandbox detonation	<i>Safe explode</i>	Running a suspect file in isolation to observe.
1003	Threat scoring	<i>Danger rating</i>	Rating how dangerous something is.
1004	Attack attribution	<i>Blame assignment</i>	Deciding which actor is responsible.
1005	Cyber kill chain	<i>Attack ladder</i>	The staged model of a full attack.
1006	Diamond model	<i>Intrusion model</i>	A model linking attacker, victim, tool, target.
1007	Pyramid of pain	<i>Indicator scale</i>	How much each clue hurts an attacker to lose.
1008	Security control test	<i>Control check</i>	Verifying a safeguard actually works.
1009	Compensating measure	<i>Backup safeguard</i>	A stand-in control when the ideal can't be used.
1010	Fail-open	<i>Open on failure</i>	Letting traffic through if a control fails.

#	TERM	ALSO CALLED	SIMPLE MEANING
1011	Fail-closed	<i>Block on failure</i>	Blocking traffic if a control fails.
1012	Watch window	<i>Alert period</i>	A time frame monitored closely.
1013	Alert tuning	<i>Rule tuning</i>	Adjusting rules to cut noise.
1014	Suppression rule	<i>Mute rule</i>	A rule that hides known-harmless alerts.
1015	Escalation path	<i>Hand-up chain</i>	Who to notify as an issue grows.
1016	On-call	<i>Standby duty</i>	Being ready to respond outside hours.
1017	Severity level	<i>Priority tier</i>	A ranked label for how urgent an issue is.
1018	Postmortem	<i>After-review</i>	A written review after an incident.
1019	Blameless review	<i>Fault-free review</i>	A review focused on fixing, not blaming.